

The opportunity

On 20 September 2026, timbuktoo UniPods is hosting "Building the Workforce of the Future" at GABI Unstoppable Africa in New York, during the UN General Assembly. The audience includes UNDP leadership, government representatives, and senior executives from global technology companies.

The programme includes a 5-minute segment showcasing one innovator from the METI AI UniPods programme. We invite you to submit a short video introducing yourself and demonstrating your AI solution. While one video will be selected for the event, strong submissions will also be featured in future UniPods and timbuktoo communications and events.

Deadline: [Friday 18 September 2PM CAT]

Maximum length: 5 minutes (videos over 5 minutes will not be considered). Shorter videos as long as they have great content are welcome, it doesn't have to be 5 minutes.

Who should submit

A team in cohort 1 of the METI AI UniPods programme with a working MVP or early-stage venture that can be shown on screen.

What we want to see

We want your story and your solution working. The audience is not technical, so imagine you are explaining it to a smart friend who has never heard of your field. Include the following but you decide how you want to sequence it.

Introduce yourself: Your name, country, UniPod or university, and one sentence on what your solution does. Start strong: the first 10 seconds decide whether people keep watching. You can have two people present if need be

The problem: Who is affected, how big the problem is, and why it matters to you personally. A real example or a real person's experience is more powerful than statistics alone.

The demo: Show your solution in action. Walk through one clear use case from start to finish, the way a real user would experience it. Use screen recording or film the product being used, and narrate what is happening and why it matters. Show the AI doing something or explain what the AI is doing.

Impact and progress: What has happened so far: users, pilots, partners, test results, feedback. Be honest and specific. "Tested with 40 farmers in two districts" is better than "impacting thousands".

Your UniPods and METI programme journey: How UniPods AI program is supporting you, and what being part of the METI AI UniPods programme means for you. You might mention the MIT Emerging Talent course, the Wadhwani entrepreneurship programme, the upcoming Addis Ababa AI Institute training, or being selected from 670 applicants across 24 countries. Tell us what you have learned or hope to gain, and where you want to take your solution etc

Close: Your vision in one sentence, and what would help you grow: partners, compute, investment, markets.

Technical requirements

- Film in landscape (horizontal), never portrait.
- Resolution of at least 1080p (Full HD). Most modern smartphones record at this quality.
- Sound matters more than image. Record in a quiet room, away from fans, traffic and echo. A phone held close or a basic clip-on microphone makes a big difference.
- Face a window or light source so your face is clearly lit. Avoid sitting with a bright window behind you.
- Keep the camera steady on a table, tripod or stack of books.
- For screen recordings, use a clean screen with notifications turned off, and zoom in so text is readable on a large projector.
- Presentation in English is preferred.
- File format: MP4 preferred.

Tips for a strong video

- Speak naturally. Practise a few times, but do not read a script word for word.
- Keep it simple. Avoid jargon and acronyms, or explain them briefly.
- Show real things: your workspace, your team, your users, your UniPod.
- Shorter is fine. A sharp 3.5-minute video beats a slow 5-minute one.
- Watch it back before sending and ask someone outside your field if they understood it.

Please avoid

- Slide presentations with voiceover in place of a demo
- Background music that competes with your voice
- Showing anyone's personal data, patient records or other sensitive information on screen
- Copyrighted music, footage or logos you do not have permission to use
- Filming people, especially children, without their consent

How to submit

1. Name your file: Country_SolutionName_YourName
2. Upload it to Google Drive or WeTransfer and set sharing to "anyone with the link can view".
3. Submit the link, together with your full name, country, UniPod, solution name, a one-line description, and your email and phone number, via email to unipods.regional@undp.org